



COGSWORTH'S LAST WIND

Official Storyboard & Visual Development Document



"Kurang satu roda gigi dari pahlawan. Kurang satu petualangan dari legenda."

"One gear short of a hero. One adventure short of a legend."

GENRE	Steampunk 2D Side-Scrolling Platformer
ENGINE	Godot Engine 4.6.2
FORMAT	A4 Portrait · Professional GDD
MISSIONS	4 Main Missions + 2 Endings
CHARACTERS	2 Playable · 5 NPCs · 1 Villain
WORLD	Aethermoor — 400 Years of Lore
TYPE	Final Project · Game Technology

§1 — VISUAL STYLE GUIDE

1.1 — Master Colour Palette

Colour extraction from production artwork. These swatches define the visual language of Aethermoor.

BG Deep Purple #1A1528 Primary background, depth layers, voids	Veilstone Violet #A96FE8 Primary accent — UI elements, headers, key highlights
Aether Teal #5BE8D8 Contrast accent — CLEM-7, steam FX, technical readouts	Soft Lavender #C9A8FF Secondary highlights, particle glow, soft light
Ghost White #EDE8F5 Primary text, clean surfaces, high contrast elements	#231C38 Secondary panels, card backgrounds
Rule Violet #352848 Dividers, subtle borders, recessed surfaces	Crimson Pink #E84875 Danger telegraphs, enemy highlights, damage states
Neon Verdant #6AE87A Safe zones, collectibles, positive feedback	Muted Violet #9080B8 Secondary text, metadata, NPC dialogue labels

1.2 — Art Style Description

LINEWORK	Bold 2–3px ink outlines with tapered ends. Mechanical elements use precise geometric strokes. Character outlines heavier than environment lines to ensure readability at game resolution.
SHADING	Cel-shaded with 2-tone lighting (base + shadow). No smooth gradients. Rim lighting in violet (#6B3FA0) used for Veilstone-adjacent scenes. Specular highlights in sharp white (#F5ECD9).
SILHOUETTE	Each character and location must be instantly readable as a silhouette. Pip: asymmetric tool belt. CLEM-7: boxy with trailing antenna. Volke: sharp coat-tail angles. All environments: distinctive skyline shape.
LIGHTING ZONES	Pip's Workshop — warm violet lantern glow with teal highlights. Bellows District — cool navy-blue industrial contrast. Suspended Library — pale lavender manuscript light + deep violet shadow. Engine Graveyard — cold blue-teal moonlight + magenta from dying machine cores. Hollow Core — full Veilstone violet surge, near-white at peak intensity.
TYPOGRAPHY	Headers: sans-serif bold, all-caps. Body: clean sans-serif 9–10pt. Technical notes: monospace (Courier). In-world text: stylised serif suggesting engraved crystal. UI elements use a Veilstone-gauge aesthetic — glowing dials, energy meters.
ANIMATION STYLE	Snappy tweening with slight overshoot. Veilstone particles: looping 4–6 frame sprite sheets in violet-to-white. Gear rotation: always mechanical (stepped, not smooth). Character idle: subtle 2-frame bob at 6fps with faint violet rim pulse.

CONSISTENCY RULES

All images share the same dark-purple background register. Violet and teal are reserved accent colours — not used for backgrounds. Every scene must have at least one atmospheric particle (Veilstone glow, steam, falling sparks). Ground planes always at bottom 20% of frame.



Fig 1.1 — Atmospheric style reference. Note the balance of mechanical decay and warm light sources.

§2 — CHARACTER SHEETS

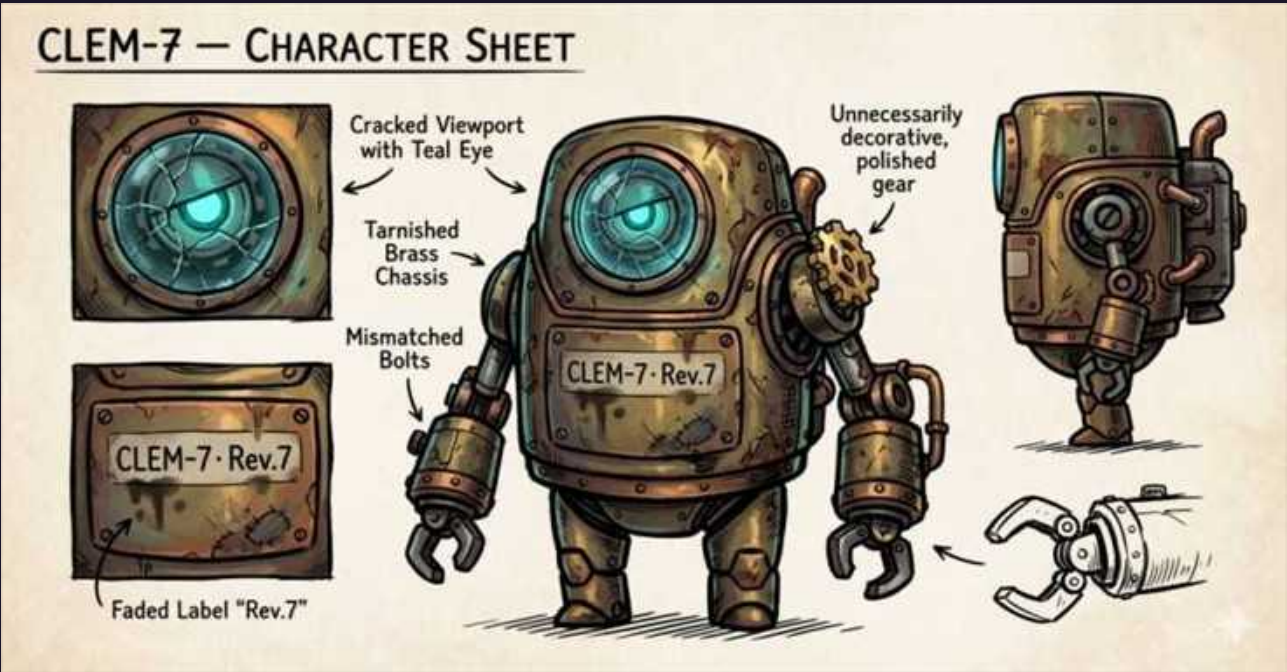


Pip Wrenshaw

PROTAGONIST · APPRENTICE MECHANIC · AGE 17

ROLE	Player character. Apprentice mechanic, heir to a legacy she doesn't yet understand.
AGE / TYPE	17 years old. Human. Female.
APPEARANCE	Worn leather apron over layered work clothes. Tool belt asymmetric — heavier on the left. Goggles pushed up on forehead. Dark hair in a practical bun, always coming loose. Scuffed boots. Grease stains that never quite wash out.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Burnt sienna (#8B4513) for clothing. Brass (#C8821A) hardware. Cream (#E8D5B0) shirt. Dark brown boots.
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	Concentrated frown that frequently transitions to alarmed squinting when plans don't work.
PERSONALITY	Stubborn, resourceful, and technically dangerous with a wrench. Has the courage typical of someone who hasn't fully registered how dangerous their situation is. Narrates her own actions like she's reading a manual — even mid-combat.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Protagonist. Heir to Cogsworth's mechanic bloodline. Sole person Veilstone will respond to. Searching for her missing father — finds a 400-year-old mystery instead.

"Step one: avoid the spinning blades. Step one failed. Initiating Step Two."



CLEM-7

SIDEKICK · CLOCKWORK LOGISTICS & EMERGENCY MODULE, REVISION 7

ROLE	AI companion and navigation unit. Officially decommissioned 50 years ago.
AGE / TYPE	Chronological age: ~90 years. Functional age: debatable. Clockwork automaton.
APPEARANCE	Squat boxy chassis with a bulbous glass viewport 'eye'. Trailing antenna — bent at an angle from unspecified incident. Worn copper plating. Maintenance panel always slightly ajar. Navigation display on chest shows incorrect information with great confidence.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Aged copper (#B87333). Brass fittings (#C8821A). Glass cyan (#7EC8C8) for eye. Rust accents (#8B4333).
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	Unblinking glass eye that somehow conveys profound smugness.
PERSONALITY	Extremely sensitive about being called 'Clem'. Provides confidently wrong navigation advice. Secretly holds the last conversation log with Aldric Cogsworth — and is not ready to share it yet. Generates maintenance reports at the worst possible dramatic moments.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Living historical record of the Cogsworth era. Knows how to open Hollow Core. Will not reveal this until the narrative requires it. Provides comedic relief through bureaucratic adherence in catastrophic situations.

"Maintenance report complete. 17 new items. — [Timing: Mid-final-battle monologue]"



Direktur Maren Volke

PRIMARY ANTAGONIST · FORMER CHIEF ENGINEER · MISSION 3–4

ROLE	Villain and final boss. Ironveil Syndicate's director. Former city chief engineer.
AGE / TYPE	Mid-50s. Human. Female. Bureaucratic-turned-revolutionary archetype.
APPEARANCE	Immaculate dark coat with sharp angular cut — a uniform she designed herself. Silver hair, tightly controlled. Mechanical eye replacement on left side, glowing faintly amber. Always carries a worn engineering notebook. Hands that still know how to fix anything.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Black (#0D0D0D) coat. Silver (#C0C0C0) hair. Amber (#C8821A) mechanical eye. Dark burgundy (#6B1A1A) lining.
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	The specific exhaustion of someone who has waited 20 years for a system to fix itself and finally gave up.
PERSONALITY	Not evil through greed — evil through exhaustion. Watched Aethermoor decay while bureaucrats debated budgets. Chose a new world over repairing the old one. Brilliant, calm, terrifyingly practical.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Primary antagonist. Final boss. Her worldview is not entirely wrong — which makes her more dangerous. Forces the player to choose between two valid interpretations of what Aethermoor is worth.

"These machines aren't broken. They're waiting for the right command. And that command... isn't yours."

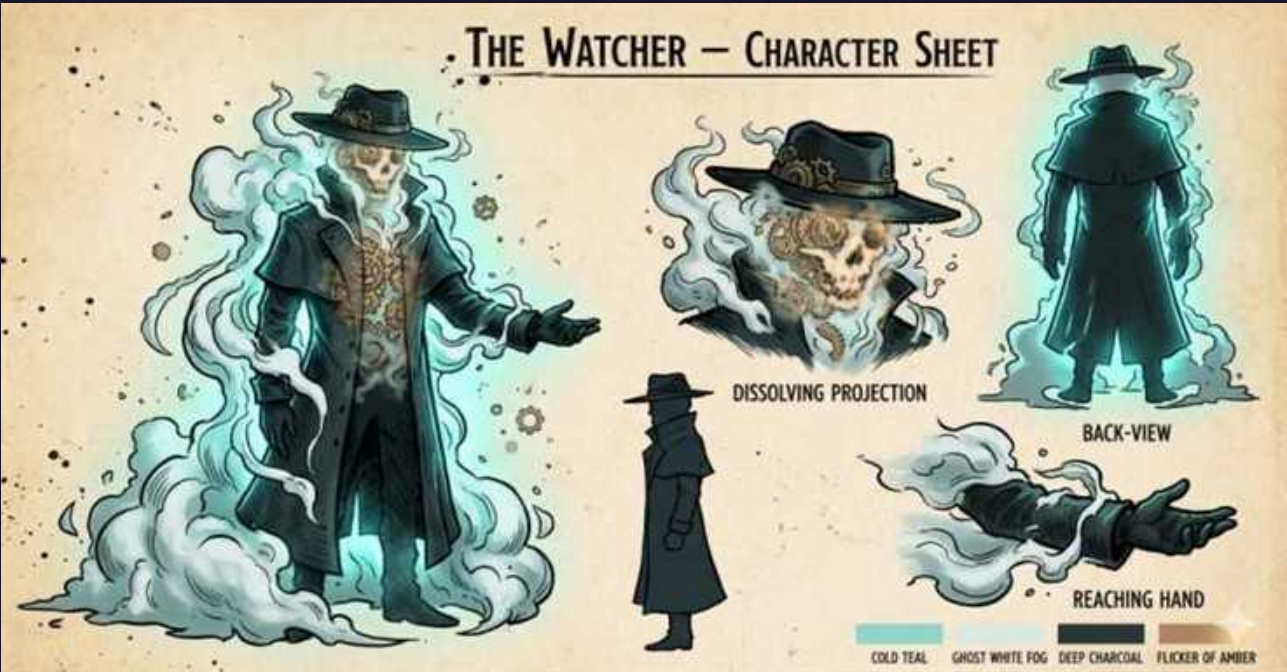


Sang Arsivist

NPC — KEEPER OF THE SUSPENDED LIBRARY · MISSION 2

ROLE	Information broker. Librarian. Has not left the Suspended Library in 80 years.
AGE / TYPE	Estimated 100+ years. Human (possibly). Gender: archivally irrelevant.
APPEARANCE	Layered robes that have absorbed decades of book dust. Ink-stained fingers on both hands. Reading spectacles on a chain that has never not been tangled. Moves with the deliberate economy of someone who has learned not to spill tea in unstable conditions.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Deep olive (#4A5E2A) robes. Aged parchment (#E8D5B0) accents. Steel (#708090) spectacle frames.
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	Polite incomprehension that anyone would consider a structural collapse more urgent than cataloguing.
PERSONALITY	Deeply unconcerned with the city's survival as long as the books are fine. Primary source of game lore. Offers tea during emergencies. Still irritated about a book borrowed in 1887.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Lore delivery. Grants access to Cogsworth's encrypted journal. Provides Mission 2 comedy beat through absolute archival indifference to impending doom.

"This is not the first time this building has had structural opinions. — [Offered while the floor collapses]"



The Watcher

MYSTERIOUS NPC · ALL MISSIONS · VOICE IN THE STEAM

ROLE	Recurring mystery figure. Leaves impossible notes. Appears as a silhouette in steam.
AGE / TYPE	400 years old. Not corporeal. Consciousness projection.
APPEARANCE	Visible only as a silhouette in steam clouds. Indistinct gender and features. Presence indicated by notes appearing in impossible locations: welded-shut boxes, underwater pipes, inside sealed clocks. In Mission 4, briefly visible as a translucent figure with Cogsworth's distinctive coat silhouette.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Silhouette black (#000000). Veilstone violet (#6B3FA0) glow at edges. Steam white (#F5F5F5) surrounding.
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	Visible only as negative space — the absence of steam in the shape of a figure.
PERSONALITY	Cryptic but ultimately benevolent. Has been watching Pip specifically for some time. Drops lore breadcrumbs across all missions. The Mission 4 reveal — that The Watcher is Cogsworth himself — reframes every prior appearance.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Mystery hook across all missions. Delivers the game's central thematic revelation in Mission 4. Serves as the voice of Aethermoor's history.

"You think you came here to save the city. The truth is — the city called for you."



Bram

SHOP NPC · THE OPPORTUNIST · MISSIONS 1 & 3

ROLE	Mobile merchant. Upgrade shop. Weapon modifications vendor.
AGE / TYPE	30s. Human. Male. Merchant archetype with suspicious inventory.
APPEARANCE	Worn long brown coat with patches and stitching throughout. Green canvas satchel worn cross-body. Goggles perched on a flat cap. Mechanical brass hand (right) — his own work, functional and obviously proud of it. Pushes a wooden handcart stamped 'BARGAIN MECHANICS — DEFINITELY LEGAL PARTS!' Broad smile that never leaves his face regardless of context.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Brown coat (#6B4423). Olive green (#4A5E2A) bag and pockets. Brass mechanical hand (#C8821A). Dark wood cart (#5C3A1E). Flat cap brown (#3D2510).
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	The welcoming smile of someone who is definitely not involved in whatever just happened.
PERSONALITY	Loyal to whoever is currently paying. Somehow present in the most dangerous locations with exactly the parts needed. Does not ask questions. Expects the same courtesy.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Shop NPC. Provides Pip with upgrade items and weapon modifications between mission sequences. Comedic presence through selective ignorance of obvious danger signs.

"Great timing. I've got exactly what you need. How I knew? Let's say I'm an optimist."



Koprall Rhen

QUEST TRIGGER NPC · THE DEFECTOR · MISSION 3

ROLE	Syndicate soldier turned reluctant ally. Provides Engine Graveyard map.
AGE / TYPE	Late 20s. Human. Male. Disillusionment arc in 90 seconds.
APPEARANCE	Ironveil Syndicate uniform — dark grey-green double-breasted coat, worn and torn at the hem. Rank insignia unevenly torn from shoulder (symbolic, not clean). Carries helmet under arm rather than wearing it — deliberate gesture of leaving post. Slightly hunched posture. Pale skin from extended underground posting. Belt with pouches, tactical backpack. Hollow-eyed expression of someone processing moral weight in real time.
DOMINANT COLOURS	Dark grey-green (#2D3A2D) uniform. Brown belt and pouches (#5C3A1E). Pale skin (#D4C5B0). Brown boots with buckle straps (#4A3020). Dark backpack (#2A2A1A).
DEFAULT EXPRESSION	The specific hollow-eyed look of a person who has realised they've been working for the wrong side.
PERSONALITY	Defected when he understood Volke's plan would kill civilians, not just redirect power. Moral: still intact. Courage: currently under construction. Provides the Engine Graveyard map in exchange for safe passage.
KEY STORY FUNCTION	Quest trigger for Mission 3. Delivers villain motivation exposition. Provides player with tactical information for the Engine Graveyard sequence.

"The map's yours. Just — make sure someone knows what she's planning. Someone who can stop it."

§3 — SCENE / ENVIRONMENT BOARDS



Pip's Workshop

OPENING LOCATION · LOWER AETHERMOOR

LOCATION	Lower residential block, Aethermoor. Pip's inherited workspace.
TIME OF DAY	Evening — artificial lantern light. No natural sunlight reaches the lower levels.
ATMOSPHERE	Controlled chaos. Warmth of a lived-in space, tension of an imminent raid. The smell of oil, hot metal, and old books she hasn't returned.
KEY PROPS	Workbench with half-assembled CLEM-7 unit. Encrypted journal fragment (father's). Wall of technical schematics. Pipe organ of pressure gauges. Emergency exit hatch (used immediately).
CAMERA ANGLE	Low three-quarter isometric for spatial establishment. Cuts to close-up on CLEM-7's eye as it activates.
COLOUR GRADING	Amber dominant (#C8821A, #8B4513). Deep shadows. Warm pool lighting from three lanterns. Cool blue from CLEM-7's awakening eye cuts against the warm palette.
STORY ROLE	Opening scene. Establishes Pip's character through environment. Introduces CLEM-7. Inciting incident: Syndicate raid forces immediate escape.
HAZARDS / INTERACTIVE	Steam pipe (can be vented to stun pursuers). Workbench (climbable shortcut). Emergency hatch (scripted exit).

Design Note: This space should feel like a character itself — lived-in and personal. The Syndicate raid that follows should feel like a violation of something intimate, not just a game event.



Bellows District Rooftops

MISSION 1 · LOWER AETHERMOOR EXTERIOR

LOCATION	Outermost skin of Aethermoor. Working-class district. Industrial infrastructure exposed.
TIME OF DAY	Night. The city's cloud layer blocks stars. Orange-tinted from distant furnace fires.
ATMOSPHERE	Precarious. Rooftops connected by improvised bridges, laundry lines, and sheer optimism. Wind constant. Steam vents fire at irregular intervals. Below — not visible, but felt.
KEY PROPS	Unstable water tanks (platforms). Steam vent grilles (timing obstacles). Syndicate drone patrol paths. Pip's father's workshop (distant, establishing shot only). Bram's handcart (first shop encounter).
CAMERA ANGLE	Side-scrolling. Occasional pull-back to reveal scale of Aethermoor above. Drones enter from screen right.
COLOUR GRADING	Deep navy-violet (#1A2040) sky. Teal-green (#2A6060) pipe-light from below. Neutral grey (#808080) for structures. Magenta (#E84875) on Syndicate drone LEDs.
STORY ROLE	Mission 1 primary environment. Pip escapes Syndicate pursuit. First encounter with Bram. First hint about father's disappearance.
HAZARDS / INTERACTIVE	Drone patrol zones (stealth avoidance). Steam vents (timing challenge). Collapsible bridges (momentum puzzles). Water tank catapults (optional speedrun path).

CLEM-7 Navigation Notes: CLEM-7 will direct Pip into a wall, a furnace, and (once) directly into a rooftop chicken coop during this sequence. All three are optional but scripted for comedic payoff.



The Suspended Library

MISSION 2 · MID-ALTITUDE AETHERMOOR

LOCATION	Hanging structure at mid-altitude. Supported by 7 chain anchors — 4 of which are failing.
TIME OF DAY	Indeterminate. Interior lit by thousands of small reading lamps. Below and above: cloud layer.
ATMOSPHERE	Fragile beauty. The impossible made real. A building full of irreplaceable things, slowly falling. Sang Arsivist appears unbothered.
KEY PROPS	Chain anchor mechanisms (Mission 2 puzzle triggers). The Blueprint Cylinder (key item). Reading carrels with 80 years of accumulated paper. Arsivist's tea service (always present). The 1887 borrowing ledger.
CAMERA ANGLE	Scrolling interior with vertical movement. Exterior shots establish scale. Chain snap moments: dynamic camera shake.
COLOUR GRADING	Soft lavender (#C9A8FF) manuscript light. Deep Veilstone violet (#A96FE8) glow from specific text sections. Deep navy (#0E0A1E) outside the windows.
STORY ROLE	Mission 2. Reveals Cogsworth's encrypted journal. First appearance of 'Wrenshaw' in historical record. Chain collapse creates urgency. Narrative twist: the Veilstone chose its successor.
HAZARDS / INTERACTIVE	Swinging chain platforms. Collapsing floor segments. Archive shelving (climbable). Blueprint extraction puzzle (timed).

Architecture Note: The Library was built to be the first thing to survive Aethermoor's fall — Cogsworth designed it to detach and float independently. This detail is discoverable but not mandatory.



The Engine Graveyard

MISSION 3 · LOWER CORE INDUSTRIAL DISTRICT

LOCATION	Former industrial heart of Aethermoor. 12 decommissioned mega-engines. Now Ironveil Syndicate HQ.
TIME OF DAY	Unknown — no windows. Lit by residual heat signatures and Syndicate floodlights.
ATMOSPHERE	A graveyard that breathes. The machines are not dead — they pulse faintly, like a heartbeat. Cold, industrial, haunted. Volke's presence has added order to the decay: precise lighting, patrol patterns, purpose.
KEY PROPS	12 great engine housings (partial activation puzzle). Kopral Rhen's defection point (alcove). Guardian Robot spawn point. Volke's command console (locked). The partial power junction (lift activation).
CAMERA ANGLE	Primarily horizontal scrolling. Vertical sections for engine interior traversal. First Volke encounter: dramatic pull-back to reveal full engine scale behind her.
COLOUR GRADING	Cold blue-violet (#1A1A3D) moonlight analogue. Teal pulse (#5BE8D8) from barely-alive engine cores. Syndicate white (#E0E0E0) floodlights creating harsh shadow lines.
STORY ROLE	Mission 3. Volke reveal. Guardian Robot boss fight. Kopral Rhen defection. Establishes that the machines are dormant, not dead — and that Volke wants to use them without Veilstone.
HAZARDS / INTERACTIVE	Chain Bridge (collapsible — gameplay mechanic). Syndicate patrol zones. Engine activation switches (partial power). Guardian Robot arena (central chamber). Ventilation ducts (stealth bypass).

Sound Design Note: The pulsing of the engines should be audible but subthreshold — felt more than heard. Players who listen carefully will notice it 3–4 minutes before the plot confirms it.



The Hollow Core

MISSION 4 · HEART OF AETHERMOOR · CLIMAX LOCATION

LOCATION	The sealed chamber at the absolute centre of Aethermoor. Cogsworth's tomb and the Veilstone altar.
TIME OF DAY	Outside time. The Veilstone creates its own light.
ATMOSPHERE	Sacred and terrible. The weight of 400 years. A space that knows it is being visited for the last time. The Veilstone's pulse matches the player's heartbeat by the time they reach the altar.
KEY PROPS	Veilstone altar (central pillar, ceiling-high). Cogsworth's preserved laboratory (walls). Final boss arena terrain. Ignition console (the choice point). The last journal page (readable only here).
CAMERA ANGLE	Wide establishing shot on entry — reveals the full altar scale. Boss fight: dynamic tracking. Final choice: slow push to close-up on Pip's face, then cut to Veilstone.
COLOUR GRADING	Full Veilstone violet (#6B3FA0) saturation. Pulsing between violet and near-white (#F0E8FF). No amber present — this is outside the world Pip knows. Gold returns only in Ending A.
STORY ROLE	Mission 4 and ending sequence. Final Volke confrontation. The Watcher reveal (Cogsworth's consciousness). The choice: sacrifice the Veilstone for Aethermoor or allow Volke to extract it.
HAZARDS / INTERACTIVE	Final boss arena (pillar terrain). Veilstone pulse wave (dodge mechanic). Ignition console (final choice trigger). Cogsworth memory fragments (optional lore pickups).

Thematic Note: This room was designed by Cogsworth for this exact moment. Every architectural choice — the lighting, the altar height, the console placement — was deliberate. The player standing here is doing exactly what Cogsworth designed for, 400 years ago.

§4 — STORYBOARD PANELS

Sequential narrative beats. Each panel represents a key story moment with illustration reference, scene description, character positioning, and dialogue/mood notes. Panels are ordered chronologically and correspond directly to in-game cutscene or gameplay transition moments.

ILLUSTRATION / VISUAL REF	SCENE DESCRIPTION · CHARACTER POSITIONS · CAMERA	DIALOGUE / NARRATION · MOOD · TRANSITION
	Panel 1 — Opening: CLEM-7 Awakens INT. PIP'S WORKSHOP — EVENING Pip leans over her workbench, soldering the final connection on CLEM-7's chassis. The workshop is warm, cluttered, safe. CLEM-7's eye flickers amber, then cyan. The eye opens fully. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Pip — foreground, hunched over bench. CLEM-7 — centre frame on the workbench, rising slowly. Workshop clutter provides depth. <i>Camera: Medium close-up on CLEM-7's eye activation. Slow pull-back to reveal full workshop. Cut to CLEM-7's perspective (fish-eye) looking at Pip.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: CLEM-7: 'Unit CLEM-7 operational. Navigation systems... 73% calibrated. Good enough.' PIP: 'Finally. I need you to—' [CRASH — Syndicate raid begins] Mood: Relief transitioning instantly to alarm. The safety of the workshop is about to end. Transition: Hard cut to EXTERIOR — drone searchlights sweep through workshop windows.
	Panel 2 — Mission 1: Rooftop Escape EXT. BELLOWS DISTRICT ROOFTOPS — NIGHT Pip runs across collapsing rooftop terrain while three Syndicate drones pursue. CLEM-7 floats/rolls alongside, emitting incorrect directions. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Pip — mid-frame, running right. CLEM-7 — just behind and left. Drones — background, converging. Steam vents — foreground, creating natural cover and obstacle. <i>Camera: Tracking side-scroll shot. Occasional pull-back to show scale of Aethermoor's exterior skin below and above. Drone POV insert shots for tension.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: CLEM-7: 'Optimal route: proceed left 40 metres, then down.' PIP: 'That's a furnace. CLEM-7: 'The furnace is technically also a valid exit.' PIP: [inaudible, running] Mood: Urgent comedy. The danger is real but CLEM-7's bureaucratic calm undercuts the panic. Transition: Match cut to Pip's boots landing on a stable platform — brief pause, then drones reappear.

	Panel 3 — Mission 2: Library Revelation INT. SUSPENDED LIBRARY — DEEP SECTION — INDETERMINATE TIME Pip holds an open blueprint cylinder. The final page of Cogsworth's journal is visible — the name 'WRENSHAW' in large mechanical type. Behind her, Arsvist pours tea. A chain anchor SNAPS in the background. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Pip — foreground, centre, staring at journal. Arsvist — mid-left, unconcerned. CLEM-7 — right background, already calculating exit. Chain anchor — far background, breaking. <i>Camera: Close-up on the journal page — 'WRENSHAW' fills the frame. Pull back to wide — shows the scale of the library and the danger simultaneously.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: PIP: '...Wrenshaw. That's my name.' CLEM-7: 'Statistically, there may be others.' ARSVIST: [from background] 'Tea? Before the floor goes, I think.' [STRUCTURAL GROAN] Mood: Revelation + absurdity. The most important discovery in the game is delivered while a building falls around them. Transition: Smash cut to chain snap — immediate platformer sequence begins.
	Panel 4 — Mission 3: First Encounter with Volke INT. ENGINE GRAVEYARD — COMMAND CHAMBER Volke stands before the largest of the 12 engines. Her back is turned. She speaks without looking at Pip. The engine thrums faintly behind her — she has partially reactivated it. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Volke — centre, back to camera, coat silhouette dominant. Pip — foreground, small against the machine scale. CLEM-7 — barely visible, pressed against the wall. <i>Camera: Low angle looking up at Volke — emphasises her dominance of the space. The engine behind her should be impossibly large in frame.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: VOLKE: 'These machines aren't broken. They're waiting for the right command.' VOLKE: [turning] 'And that command... isn't yours.' PIP: '...is it yours?' VOLKE: [pause, almost smiling] 'Not yet.' Mood: Cold intelligence. Volke is not threatening — she is simply correct, and that is more frightening. Transition: Guardian Robot activates. Boss fight transition sequence begins.
	Panel 5 — Mission 4: The Final Choice INT. HOLLOW CORE — VEILSTONE ALTAR Pip stands at the ignition console. Volke is defeated — unconscious or fled. The Veilstone pulses violet. The city shakes. CLEM-7 stands to one side. The Watcher's silhouette — now clearly Cogsworth — is visible in the Veilstone's glow. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Pip — centre, hands on console. Console — foreground. Veilstone altar — background, dominant. CLEM-7 — left. Cogsworth silhouette — diffuse in the Veilstone light. <i>Camera: Extreme close-up on Pip's hands on the console. Pull back to reveal the full altar. Final frame: Pip's face in violet light.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: COGSWORTH [voice from Veilstone]: 'You think you came here to save the city. The truth is — the city called for you.' CLEM-7 [whispered]: 'Maintenance report complete. 17 new items.' PIP: 'Diam, CLEM.' CLEM-7: 'Noted. Item 18: Pip told me to be quiet.' Mood: Sacred gravity punctured by perfect comedy. The choice feels real. CLEM-7 undercuts it, then the weight returns. Transition: Player makes the choice — branches to Ending A or Ending B.

	Panel 6 — Ending A: City Reignites (Good Ending) EXT. AETHERMOOR — MULTIPLE LOCATIONS — DAWN Sequence of shots: The Veilstone flares white-gold. Machines throughout Aethermoor activate in sequence — lights, engines, trams, the great pipes. The city breathes again. Pip and CLEM-7 on a rooftop, watching. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Final shot — Pip and CLEM-7 from behind, facing the dawn. City spread before them, lit and alive. Cogsworth's silhouette, fading. <i>Camera: Rapid montage of citywide activation. Culminating in slow pan across the skyline. Final shot: Pip and CLEM-7, small against the enormous living city.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: COGSWORTH [final, fading]: 'Don't ever let the fire go out.' CLEM-7: 'City systems: optimal. Pending maintenance items: 17. Shall I begin the report?' PIP: [long pause, smiling] 'Yeah. Start the report.' Mood: Earned warmth. The comedy of CLEM-7's report now feels like continuity — life going on. Cogsworth rests. Transition: Credits sequence. City montage continues under credits.
	Panel 7 — Ending B: City Falls (Dark Ending) EXT./INT. AETHERMOOR — COLLAPSE SEQUENCE Volke escapes with the Veilstone. The machines stop. The city's systems fail in sequence. Aethermoor begins its long descent. Pip and CLEM-7 board an emergency escape vessel. CHARACTER POSITIONS: Pip — foreground, watching Aethermoor recede. CLEM-7 — beside her, eye dimmed slightly. Aethermoor — background, slowly tilting, lights going dark. <i>Camera: Pull back through escape vessel porthole — Aethermoor grows smaller as they descend. Final frame holds on the city disappearing into clouds.</i>	Dialogue/Narration: PIP: 'We're still alive.' CLEM-7: 'Yes. Though I note the navigation system currently shows no destination.' PIP: [quiet] 'Neither do we.' CLEM-7: 'I will update the log. Destination: unknown. Status: proceeding anyway.' [No more dialogue. City lights go out.] Mood: Muted grief. Not despair — determination. Pip is already thinking about what comes next. CLEM-7's log entry is unexpectedly moving. Transition: Credits sequence. Single point of light remains where Aethermoor was — possibly Veilstone, still alive.

§5 — GAMEPLAY ILLUSTRATION BOARDS

Steam Gauntlet



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

Rhythmic steam burst obstacles positioned throughout vertical and horizontal passages. Steam vents are embedded in walls, floors, and ceilings. Each vent has a visible pressure gauge that rises before the burst — providing clear visual telegraph.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Navigate through steam-filled passages using the rhythm of vent cycles. Reach the far side without being knocked back or damaged by full-pressure bursts. Optional: use steam bursts as momentum boosts with precise timing.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

Pressure gauge animation (3 phases: fill, red-line, BURST). Steam colour shift from white (safe) to orange (warning) to full opaque white (danger). Screen edge vignette when player is too close to an active vent. Audio: ascending hiss frequency.

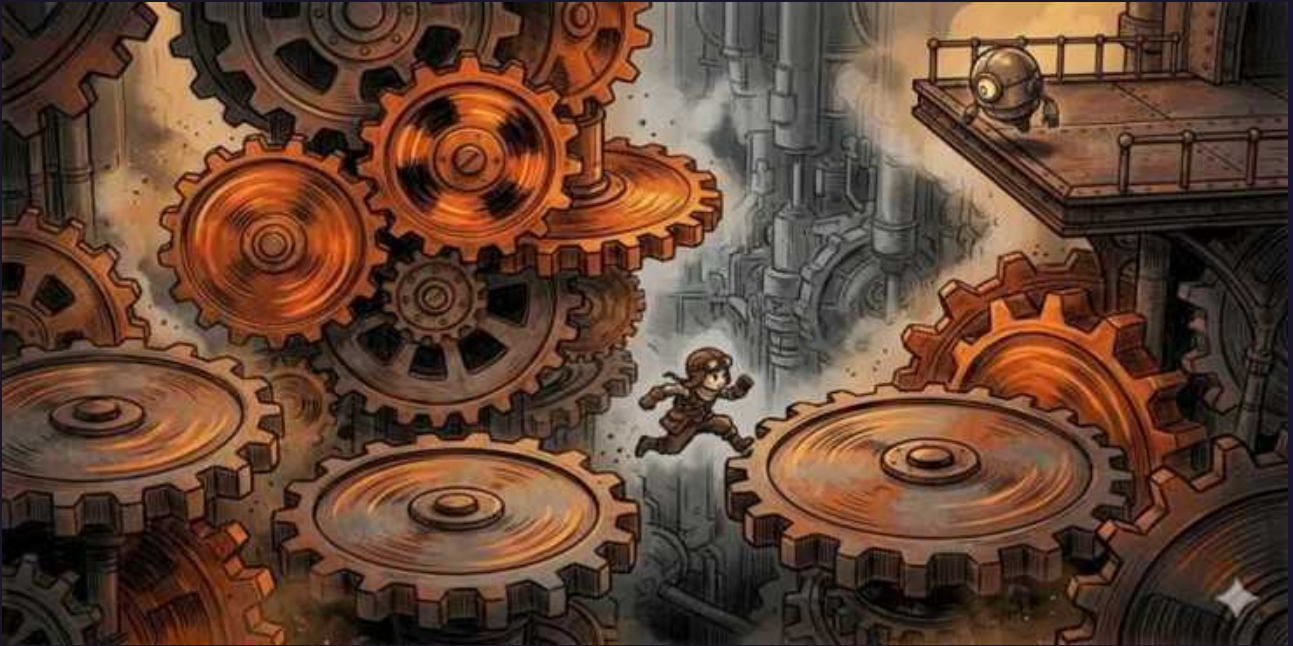
DIFFICULTY CUE

Beginner: Single-direction vents, 3-second safe windows. Advanced: Cross-pattern vents, 1.5-second windows. Elite: Diagonal vents with variable timing.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

Timer + AnimatedSprite2D Area2D damage zones
Particle2D for steam Audio: pitch-shifted loop

Gear Platform Sequence



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

Large rotating gear platforms that begin spinning when a player lands on them. Rotation speed increases over time. Standing still causes the player to slide off the edge; continuous movement maintains footing. Platform connects to other gears — stepping off one may accelerate an adjacent one.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Cross a series of gear platforms without falling. Momentum management is key — stopping causes loss of footing. Chain reactions between adjacent gears can create shortcuts or hazards depending on approach.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

Gear rotation speed visually obvious from approach angle. Directional arrow indicators on gear faces (subtle). Platform edges glow amber as rotation accelerates. Character sprite leans into centrifugal direction.

DIFFICULTY CUE

Basic: Single gear, slow rotation, wide platform. Intermediate: Gear chains, varied rotation direction. Expert: Gear pairs counter-rotating with narrow timing windows.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

`AnimatableBody2D Rotate_toward()` or tween `Timer` for acceleration `Body_entered` for trigger

Drone Chase Sequence



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

Syndicate patrol drones use periodic spotlight sweeps. A drone's spotlight follows a scripted patrol path with consistent intervals. Players caught in the spotlight trigger an alarm — spawning a secondary drone pursuit wave. Steam clouds in the environment provide cover.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Traverse the patrol zone without triggering the alarm. Time movements to occur in spotlight gaps. Use steam cloud cover for riskier movement. Triggering the alarm initiates a chase — survive 30 seconds or find a reset point.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

Spotlight cone clearly visible with gradient edge (safe @ detected). Audio: patrol drone hum, rising tone when player is nearly detected. Player sprite has a 'caution' indicator (small icon) when adjacent to spotlight path. Full alarm: screen edge red flash.

DIFFICULTY CUE

Tutorial: Single drone, 90-degree arc. Standard: Two drones, overlapping patterns. Elite: Three drones, variable timing, narrow steam cover windows.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

RayCast2D + Area2D NavigationAgent2D Light2D
for spotlight Signal: body_entered alarm

Chain Bridge Collapse



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

A multi-segment chain bridge begins collapsing from one end as the player starts crossing. Each bridge segment has a collapse timer — visible via cracking visual effect. Players must reach the far side before the segment beneath them falls. Running backwards is not viable after a certain point.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Cross the chain bridge before it fully collapses. Manage speed — too slow means falling segments; too fast risks missing the rhythm of which segments are safe. Optional collectibles are placed on segments that collapse earliest.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

Bridge segment cracking animation (3 phases: intact, stress lines, fracture). Segment sway increases before collapse. Audio: metallic groan with distinct pitch per segment. Brief particle burst when segment falls — direction indicates momentum of fall.

DIFFICULTY CUE

Short: 6 segments, even collapse timing. Long: 12 segments, irregular collapse timing. Elite: Reverse collapse (far end first) requiring backtracking decision.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

RigidBody2D segments Joint2D connections Timer per segment Deletion with Tween fade

Boss Fight: Guardian Robot (Mission 3)



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

The Guardian Robot is a repurposed industrial machine — 4 metres tall, original purpose: cargo loading. Volke has modified it for combat. Three attack phases, each triggered by HP threshold. Phase 1: Ground slams. Phase 2: Tracking missile pods activate. Phase 3: Heat core exposed — vulnerability window.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Defeat the Guardian Robot through three phases. Exploit the vulnerability windows between each phase transition. Use the arena terrain (pillars, elevated platforms) to avoid AoE ground attacks. During Phase 3: hit the heat core before it reseals.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

HP bar visible with clear phase transition markers. Phase change: full arena flash + Guardian animation sequence (unmissable telegraph). Heat core: glows bright orange when vulnerable, dims when resealing. Damage numbers appear on hit.

DIFFICULTY CUE

Phase 1: Predictable, learning phase. Phase 2: Requires active evasion. Phase 3: Tight timing window — increases urgency without adding new mechanics.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

StateMachine node AnimationPlayer per phase
Hitbox Area2D (core) HP signal @
phase_change()

Boss Fight: Final Confrontation (Mission 4)



MECHANIC DESCRIPTION

Director Maren Volke, armed with experimental Veilstone extraction equipment. Not a standard combat boss — Volke fights using redirected Veilstone energy and mechanical countermeasures. Three phases mirror the game's thematic arc: control (Phase 1), desperation (Phase 2), revelation (Phase 3). In Phase 3, Volke's equipment fails — she fights with raw engineering skill.

PLAYER OBJECTIVE

Defeat Volke without destroying her — the game's final choice foreshadows Ending A vs B based on how the player approaches the final phase. Phase 3 victory condition: disarm, not defeat. Player choices here influence ending cinematic tone.

VISUAL FEEDBACK / TELEGRAPH

Veilstone energy attacks: violet (#6B3FA0) with white (#F0E8FF) core — visually distinct from all other hazards. Phase transitions: Volke's coat changes from pristine to damaged. Phase 3: equipment sparks and fails visually before HP threshold.

DIFFICULTY CUE

Non-standard progression: Phase 1 hardest, Phase 3 easiest — mirrors Volke's state of collapse. Rewards players who understand the narrative over those who grind combat.

GODOT IMPLEMENTATION

StateMachine + DialogueManager Animation:
coat_damage state Ending variable set on
phase_3_end Cinematic trigger on defeat

§6 — STYLE ANCHOR REFERENCE

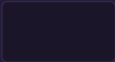
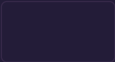
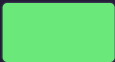
6.1 — Visual Consistency Checklist

3 BACKGROUNDS	Always dark-registered. Primary backgrounds draw from C_BG (#0D0A06) or C_PANEL (#1A1410). Never white, never neutral grey as a primary field.
3 ACCENT DISCIPLINE	Veilstone violet (#A96FE8) and aether teal (#5BE8D8) are RESERVED accents. Do not use as field fills. Use for highlights, UI elements, special FX only.
3 LAVENDER GLOW	Soft lavender (#C9A8FF) is exclusively for: Veilstone particle FX, CLEM-7 eye glow, energy readout text. Not for decorative use.
3 CHARACTER OUTLINES	All character sprites: 2–3px solid outline, darker than body colour. Environment elements: 1–2px outline. UI elements: 0.5–1px outline or none.
3 SILHOUETTE TEST	Every asset must be readable as a silhouette at 50% scale. If not, revise the shape design before adding colour.
3 LIGHTING ZONES	Respect zone-specific lighting (see 1.2). Do not carry warm workshop amber into the Engine Graveyard or vice versa. Colour grading is narrative information.
3 GEAR MOTIF	Gear elements are decorative accents, not backgrounds. Maximum 3 visible gears in any single frame. They should always be mechanical (turning with purpose) not ornamental.
3 TEXT LEGIBILITY	All in-game text must be legible at minimum display size (720p). Test at 50% resolution. Body text minimum: 9pt equivalent. Never place text on busy backgrounds without a backing panel.
3 PARTICLE SCALE	Steam and spark particles: maximum 15px at base resolution. Particle count: max 40 simultaneous. Performance constraint.
3 ANIMATION SNAPPINESS	All character animations: snappy with 2-frame anticipation, 1-frame overshoot. No smooth/floaty movement. This is a clockwork world — everything moves with mechanical precision.

6.2 — Do's and Don'ts

3 DO • Use mechanical, purposeful motion for all animated elements • Maintain dark background register across all scenes • Reserve Veilstone violet for accent/highlight use only • Ensure all character silhouettes are distinct and readable • Include at least one atmospheric particle per scene (steam, sparks, debris) • Telegraph all gameplay hazards with 2+ visual phases before activation • Let CLEM-7's dialogue undercut tense scenes — it's a feature, not a bug • Use violet exclusively for Veilstone-related elements • Respect zone colour grading as narrative information • Design for gameplay readability first, aesthetic second	7 DON'T • Use white, light grey, or bright colours as background fills • Use violet or teal as large background fills — they are accent colours • Use brass amber or warm orange — this is a cool-tone palette • Make any character or hazard read ambiguously in silhouette • Use brass amber for Veilstone effects (reserve violet for this) • Animate with smooth/floaty physics — all motion is mechanical • Place unreadable text against busy backgrounds • Introduce new colour accents not in the master palette without approval • Make Volke's motivation cartoonishly evil — she must remain sympathetic • Sacrifice gameplay readability for visual complexity
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6.3 — Master Colour Reference

 BG_DEEP #1A1528 Primary background	 #231C38 Card and panel fills	 RULE_LINE #352848 Borders and dividers
 VEILSTONE_VIO #A96FE8 Primary accent — reserved	 AETHER_TEAL #5BE8D8 Contrast accent — reserved	 SOFT_LAVENDER #C9A8FF Particle glow, soft highlights
 TEXT_WHITE #EDE8F5 Primary body text	 TEXT_MUTED #9080B8 Secondary text, metadata	 DANGER_PINK #E84875 Hazard telegraphs, damage
 SAFE_GREEN #6AE87A Safe zones, positive states	 VEILSTONE_WH #F5F0FF Veilstone peak energy	 DEEP_VIOLET #4A3080 Deep shadow, recessed layers

"The gears must turn — or the world goes dark."